

tutes, including the Tata Institute of Fundamental Research in Mumbai. Debian is light on system resources, needing just about 500 MB of disk space for a minimal install. You can download Debian from www.debian.org/CD.

8.1.5 Ubuntu

Ubuntu is available both as a Live CD and as a full-fledged installation. Ubuntu is a derivative of Debian, and packs in some handy features. It comes with the GNOME desktop environment, and doesn't tax your system resources.



Ubuntu is an African word that means “humanity to others.” The word also conveys the idea of peace and co-existence. Ubuntu has been created by Mark Shuttleworth and Canonical Ltd. Canonical Ltd has been involved with open source, and has announced that it will render support for Ubuntu Linux. Ubuntu is available in a choice of many languages which must enable users from across countries and regions to make good use of the operating system. (Incidentally, “Ubuntu” also happens to be the name of an organisation that works for the African cause.)

For all the niceties packed in Ubuntu, the lack of a GUI during installation could be its undoing, though the keyboard interface is quite easy and help is available on-screen. But for those who are just too used to a GUI everywhere, installation may be a little uncomfortable. This apart, Ubuntu syncs with the user with ease. Ubuntu packs with it OpenOffice.org, Thunderbird, Firefox, media players and system tools for all your computing needs. All this in just a one CD installer!

Ubuntu has a special feature: it doesn't allow a root login through the GUI. You have to login as a user and then switch to root in the terminal. This reduces the chances of accidentally changing anything critical.

Ubuntu is currently in version 5.10, and the next version, 6.04,